Lio

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FOUNDERS ASSOCIATE APPLICATION · CEO & CTO OFFICE · SEPTEMBER 2026

Pipeline, rooms & proof

A day-0 plan for the founders' office. Who buys Lio, where they gather, and the machine I would run to get them there.

Every number in this deck ships with a working file: the list, the calendar, the budget, the register. Receipts in the appendix.

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Who am I and what do I bring to the table?

Experience spans consulting to VC. Now driving Strategy, AI and GTM at SCAILE.

PHOTO

Experience

SCAILE Technologies

Driving Strategy, AI and GTM. I build B2B go-to-market engines from scratch, from ICP research through outbound to AI search visibility.

Alvarez & Marsal

Advised Fortune 500 CEOs on restructuring financial liabilities worth >$100M.

Biome VC

Built an investment thesis that shaped the investment philosophy of a $170M VC fund.

Education

Nova School of Business and Economics, Lisbon FT #8 WORLDWIDE

MSc Finance. **Top 10% of class.**

Won top prize in National Case Study Competitions (among 15,000+ participants).

Why Lio

1 Shortest path to founding my own.

I want to found my own startup, and nothing gets me closer than the founders' office of a company at its inflection point. Fresh off a $30M a16z Series A, rebranding into a category, opening the US. This is the phase where I learn to lay the bricks.

2 Lio sells against a $180B line, not a $10B one.

Everyone else builds procurement software. Lio replaces the execution labour, the same BPO scope at ~7% of cost. It is the sharpest enterprise wedge I have seen since I started working in GTM, and the market has barely heard it yet.

3 I like building things.

As a VC analyst I spent 100+ hours with founders and operators, learning what breaks. At SCAILE I build the playbook from scratch. For this application I already built Lio's: 219 named buyers of 2,245 identified, a re-verified 17-event programme, and a 60-post share-of-voice audit. All of it ships as working files.

DAY-TO-DAY STACK Claude Code · Apollo · Clay · Figma · Webflow · Notion · HubSpot · Sheets

COMPANY FACTS PER LIO'S SERIES A RELEASE (2026-03-05) AND THE LIO/A16Z $180B-VS-$10B THESIS · OWN FIGURES AS IN THE ZEIT AI DECK

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The what, why and how

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How this deck is structured, and what I would drive once I join the team.

How the deck is structured

01	Who buys Lio, sourced and counted	FINDINGS
02	Where they gather: the event pipeline, re-verified	FINDINGS
03	What the market hears on LinkedIn	FINDINGS
04	What I would own from day 0	STRATEGY
05	Why hire me, and what you get in return	THE OFFER
06	What it costs, and what it returns	THE ASK

Brief summary

1. **The ICP is countable.** 219 named buyers of the 2,245 identified, across 4 segments. Outbound can start on day 0.
2. **The trigger is not the one we assumed.** One true third-party BPO in 35 swept accounts. In DACH the target is the captive SSC, and what starts the conversation is a change event.
3. **The event plan is live now.** The late-September gauntlet starts in two weeks, and every date is re-verified against organiser sources.
4. **Share of voice is founder-heavy and customer-silent.** The company posts, the market barely echoes, and nobody owns the fix.
5. **Everything ships with working files.** Spreadsheets, CSVs, registers. Not slideware.

Goals I want to achieve

Short term

1. **Own event ops end to end for Q3/Q4:** target lists per room, founder briefs, the sidecar dinners, and the next-day follow-ups nobody has time for.
2. **Stand up the ICP outbound engine:** keep the named-buyer list alive in Apollo, feed sequences with the AEs, and report what converts.
3. **Give Keil and Wagner leverage:** prep, notes, pipeline hygiene and the analysis layer of the $10M Challenge. Founders get hours back, every week.

Long term

1. **Own a slice of the US field engine** as the NYC pod scales. The Q2-27 calendar already requires a field-marketing layer.
2. **Run the displacement campaign end to end:** from the SSOW/SIG rooms to qualified pilots. The "93% cheaper" story deserves its own funnel.
3. **Earn ownership of a revenue line:** complete ownership of one repeatable motion, the way Lio defines new roles for its customers.

The through-line: three findings built from public sources before day 0, one machine to run them, and one ask priced against what that machine returns.

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The market is countable. The trigger is not the one the plan assumed

219 named buyers are ready for outbound. The renewal trigger behind them holds in FS and the US, and breaks in DACH.

SEGMENT	BUYERS IN APOLLO	ON THE LIST	THE BUYING CENTRE	HOW TO APPROACH
DACH industrial backbone Searched €1–12B · **bullseye €2.8–4.7B, 8–30K staff** · ~⅔ family/foundation-owned	**851** TITLED MATCHES	**60** NAMED · LINKEDIN	**CPO sponsors, COO/CFO signs** via the SSC/FTE line; Procurement Excellence champions; CIO gatekeeps.	**Trust-first, German, in person, and timed to a change event.** The DACH trigger is the captive SSC/GBS, not a BPO renewal: carve-outs, post-merger integration, hub migrations.
Insurance & financial services 100% indirect spend · Munich Re, ERGO class	**156** TITLED MATCHES	**40** NAMED · LINKEDIN	**Head of Procurement / Sourcing & Vendor Mgmt**; compliance-heavy, auditability opens the door.	**Where the real renewals sit.** Zurich–Genpact (since 2012) is the one confirmed third-party procurement BPO in 35 swept accounts. Lead with the 93%-cheaper wedge.
US F500 GBS & BPO owners The people who sign outsourcing renewals · SSOW/SIG audience	**895** TITLED MATCHES	**60** NAMED · LINKEDIN	**VP GBS / Shared Services, Head of P2P, GPOs.** A persona classic procurement marketing barely reaches.	**Budget capture, and the segment where renewals actually concentrate.** Every renewal is a qualified opp with a price to beat by 93%; Petras + Walmart engagement as credibility.
DACH utilities & mobility Regulated, process-heavy · DB (“Loom”), SWM, Lufthansa class	**343** TITLED MATCHES	**59** NAMED · LINKEDIN	**Leiter Einkauf / Beschaffung** + digitalisation leads; works councils in the room from day one.	**Follow the Deutsche Bahn breadcrumb.** Regulated buyers move on references and auditability; German-language webinars → Bots & Buyers → pilot.

219

NAMED BUYERS ON THE LIST
122 COMPANIES

The outbound cold-start problem is solved before day 0. Every contact carries title, company, location and LinkedIn URL; 193 carry verified work emails, including prospect CPOs at Allianz, Deutsche Bahn, E.ON, ServiceNow, Citi, Beiersdorf and Miele. Apollo identifies **2,245 titled buyers** on the same filters (851 DACH industrial · 156 insurance/FS · 895 US GBS · 343 utilities/mobility). The refill pool is documented and reusable. Full list, companies tab and approach playbook: **Lio_ICP_Prospect_List.xlsx**

H1 RADAR SWEEP → 35 accounts swept for BPO/SSC evidence: **one true third-party procurement BPO** (Zurich–Genpact) plus one Accenture JV, 4 captive centres with a live change event, 16 stable captives, 9 clean controls. **The DACH displacement target is the captive SSC, which has no renewal date**, so the trigger there is a change event, and the renewal-timed motion belongs to FS and the US.

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The rooms are picked and the dates hold. The programme now needs one owner

€929K and 204 staff-days across 17 events, with four starting in two weeks and no single owner below the founders.

	Q3-2026 · IN 2 WEEKS	Q4-2026	Q1-2027	Q2-2027
The gauntlet runs 4 P1 events + Bots & Buyers NYC · 18 days · 2 continents. Split: Keil+Heinzmann → Amsterdam, Wagner+Petras → Boston.	SSON San Diego · Sep 14–17 + Bots & Buyers NYC · Sep 23 (own) ProcureCon EU Köln · Sep 22–24 ProcureCon East Boston · Sep 28–30 · lead DPW Amsterdam · Sep 30–Oct 1	SIG Fall Chicago · Oct 25–28 · Petras SSOW DACH Berlin · Nov 17–19 BME-Symposium Berlin · Nov 18–19 Berlin double-week holds. B&B EU Munich (Oct 27–28, own) collides with SIG Chicago. **Split settled: Petras → Chicago, Keil+Wagner → Munich, Heinzmann → demo stage**, conditional on SIG scheduling the buy-side session Oct 25–26.	ProcureCon West Vegas · Mar 8–10 · committed SSOW Orlando · Mar 8–11 · BPO keynote APC · Mar 22–24 · now New Orleans Same-week collision resolved: Keil → Orlando, Petras → Vegas.	Handelsblatt Apr 6–7 · Gartner SC May 3–5 · NAPES tbd eLösungstage May 11–12 · WPC London May 18–20 DPW NY Jun 2–3 · Proc. Summit HH Jun 23–24 7 events. Breaks the current team without the Jan-27 field-marketing hire.
	€165K NEW + €70K COMMITTED · 65 STAFF-DAYS	€87K · 32 STAFF-DAYS · CHEAPEST, SHARPEST	€108K + €35K COMMITTED · 31 STAFF-DAYS	€376K · 76 STAFF-DAYS · THE HEAVY QUARTER

Status check, six weeks after the plan was written: all four gauntlet dates hold. New since the plan: **Bots & Buyers went transatlantic.** NYC Sep 23 (application-only, mid-gauntlet) and the EU flagship Oct 27–28, **colliding with SIG Chicago (Oct 25–28)**. The split is now settled, with Oct 25–26 scheduling made a condition of the SIG booking. APC 2027 moved **Miami → New Orleans**. NAPES' reported Denver move is **unverified**, so hold the €35K. Two early-birds close **Sep 30**: BME-Symposium (€100) and eLösungstage (€300).

17

P1 EVENTS
Q3-26 → Q2-27

€736K new + €105K committed + 12% contingency ≈ €929K envelope · 204 staff-days · 10 sidecar dinners (€120K of the total, and the line to protect last).
This programme currently has no single owner below the founders. That is the job I am applying to do, starting with the four events that begin in two weeks.

WHICH SEAT EACH ROOM HOLDS

The buying committee has four seats and **no single event reaches more than two.** Sponsor (CPO) sits in Handelsblatt, WPC, DPW and the dinners; economic buyer (COO/CFO) in SSOW ×3, SIG and SSON San Diego; champion in the German BME fairs; gatekeeper (CIO/CISO) in IT-Sourcing and the Gartner symposia.

WHAT THE RECOMPUTED ICP SAYS ABOUT THIS SPEND

The 17 verified customers cluster at **€2.8–4.7B revenue, 8–30K staff**. That is exactly the German practitioner fairs' demographic, and the cheapest fit per euro on the calendar. The US circuit aims a tier higher against **zero verified US customers.**

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One voice carries the category, and the 150-logo customer wall is silent

60 indexed posts. Keil authors 40% of them, and customers author none.

Posts found, by who is talking

Vladimir Keil (CEO) the channel, effectively	24
Lio company page incl. the askLio era	9
Third-party commentary analysts, influencers, reactions	9
Heinzmann & Wagner (CTO/COO)	7
Lio team (“Lions”) Petras, new-hire posts, FDE Night	7
Investors & network YC, a16z orbit	4
Customers despite a 150+ enterprise logo wall	**0 posts found**

Found via search-engine indexing of linkedin.com, so this is a floor rather than a census. The login wall hides an unknown share of posts. Direction is what matters.

One voice carries 40% of the channel

Keil authors 24 of 60 indexed posts; the founder team together, 31. That is a single point of failure, and also the cheapest amplifier available. Founder-content ops (drafts, recaps, clips) multiplies an asset that already works.

The logo wall is silent

Zero customer-authored posts, despite award-grade stories at Schaeffler (MOU), REHAU (BME + Porsche Consulting AI Impact Award 2026) and Surventis. Every go-live, award and dinner should ship with a co-marketing ask. Nobody owns that ask today.

Moments, not a cadence

Activity spikes at the YC launch, the BME award, Schaeffler milestones and the Series A, then goes quiet. The 17-room P1 calendar, plus Lio's own franchises, is a built-in content engine if every room produces before/during/after posts. That loop needs an owner.

60

DISTINCT POSTS IN THE REGISTER

Share of voice is founder-heavy and customer-silent. That is an ops gap, not a budget gap, and the events → content → advocacy loop I would run closes it. Full register with URLs, authors, dates and themes: **14-linkedin-posts.md**

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I own the machine between the founders and the pipeline: the list, the rooms, and the follow-through.

One line, because that is the job: everything repeatable that stands between a named buyer and a booked founder conversation. In practice, the first 90 days:

LIVE · DAY 0–30

The gauntlet

Four P1 events plus Bots & Buyers NYC in 18 days across two continents, starting in two weeks. I run the ops: **target lists per room, founder briefs, the sidecar dinners, next-day follow-ups.** The 219-name buyer list goes into sequences before the first flight.

NEXT · DAY 30–60

The wedge quarter

Berlin double-week + SIG Chicago, the rooms where the budget owners sit: **third-party BPO in the US/FS rooms, captive SSC and GBS heads in the DACH ones.** I own room prep and the follow-up motion, pipe every conversation into the CRM, and ship the first outbound-cohort report.

ONGOING · DAY 60–90

The machine, boring on purpose

Calendar → list → room → follow-up → pipeline, **measured weekly and running without heroics.** Founders get hours back; the Q1-27 US quarter starts planned, staffed and booked early instead of rushed.

THE WORKFORCE I'D BE SELLING · "85% OF PROCUREMENT OPERATIONS ARE DONE BY LIO AGENTS"

Freetext Agent · Search Agent · Guided Buying Agent · Approvals Agent · RFQ Agent · PR Review Agent · Supplier Onboarding Agent · Order Confirmation Agent · Goods Receipt Agent · Invoice Agent · Sourcing Agent · Negotiation Agent · Contract Negotiation Agent · Lio Assistant · Procurement Intelligence · Agent Supervisor

AGENT ROSTER PER LIO.AI/PRODUCT VIA 02-PRODUCT-AND-FEATURES.MD · 85% CLAIM IS LIO'S OWN, COMPANY-REPORTED

Lio

Why hire me, and what you get in return

Not potential. Output you can inspect before day 0.

What you get

01 An operator in the founders' office who ships unmanaged.

This deck, the named-buyer ICP list, the re-verified event programme, the LinkedIn audit and the H1 hypothesis test were **built before day 0, from public information.** That is the working speed you hire, not a promise of it.

02 The outbound cold-start problem, already solved.

219 named, titled, LinkedIn-linked buyers across four ICP segments, 193 of them with verified work emails, and an approach playbook for each. **The AEs and SDRs start warm**, and the list machine keeps refilling it.

03 A ~€1M event programme run with owner-level care.

17 P1 events, 204 staff-days, 10 sidecar dinners. The highest-ROI line in the GTM budget currently has **no single owner below the founders.** I am that owner. Deadlines tracked, rooms prepped, every conversation followed up.

04 A profile that spans the room.

Consulting rigour (A&M, Fortune 500 CFO work), investor pattern-matching (Biome VC) and hands-on GTM engineering (SCAILE). **CFO-grade analysis down to SDR-grade execution**, the exact range a founders' associate needs.

The guarantee

ZERO BULLSHIT

Lio promises customers **$10M in identified value, or donates $100K.** Same energy, scaled to me:

If after 90 days you would not enthusiastically re-hire me, I hand over the machine (documented, running, transferable) and we shake hands.

No ramp-up excuses. No knowledge hostage-taking.

90

DAYS TO PROVE IT.
THE MACHINE STAYS EITHER WAY.

Lio

The base case returns the year-one salary thirteen times over

A market-anchored ask, priced against the H1 thesis in three scenarios.

The return · H1 thesis ARR, year 1

€0–175K

KILL · ROTATE

The funnel fails its own gate.

0–1 contracts. Assessment → POC under 10%, POC → contract under 20%, which are **file 17's own kill thresholds.** The motion rotates to the next-best hypothesis. Phase 0 costs ~€0, which is the whole point of testing before spending.

€1.35M

REFINE · NARROW BASE CASE

Signal in FS only. DACH stays captive.

~2 FS-anchor wins at ~€500K + ~2 DACH change-event wins at ~€175K. **This is already today's read:** Zurich–Genpact is the one confirmed third-party BPO in 35 swept accounts. DACH runs on captive-SSC change events with no renewal date.

€2.4M

CONFIRM · SCALE

Both segments clear the confirm bar.

~3 FS + ~5 DACH wins as the Renewal Radar scales 35 → ~75 accounts and conversion clears **assessment → POC 30%, POC → contract 50%**. Carries into the already-funded Q1/Q2-27 US wave once SOC 2 closes.

WHAT MOVES THESE NUMBERS · THE THREE LOAD-BEARING ASSUMPTIONS

ACV. No public ACV exists. ~7% of displaced cost is Lio's own disclosed mechanic. One verified POC replaces the whole estimate.

Radar scale. 35 accounts swept, 50–100 targeted. Every 10 added yields ~2 more Group-A triggers at today's 17% hit rate.

Segment mix. An FS win is worth ~3× a DACH win. Invert which segment converts and the base case roughly halves.

The ask

MARKET-ANCHORED

€95–120K

BASE, YEAR 1 · ANCHOR €105K

+ 0.05–0.15% equity, standard 4-year vest, 1-year cliff.

Re-rated twice: at day 90 (the guarantee, previous slide) and at the H1 decision gate, Jan–Feb 2027.

Munich/Berlin founders-associate postings run €51–90K (Glassdoor 2026). Scoped above that median for a CEO-and-CTO-office mandate and A&M / Biome-VC seniority, and deliberately under the US Series-A chief-of-staff band. A proposed anchor, not a demand.

13×

BASE-CASE ARR ÷ YEAR-1 BASE.
CONFIRM CASE CLEARS IT 23×. ONLY KILL DOESN'T, WHICH IS EXACTLY WHAT THE TEST IS FOR.

MODELED, NOT FORECAST. ACV AT ~7% OF DISPLACED BPO/SSC COST (FILE 08) · FUNNEL PER FILE 17'S DECISION GATE. FULL MATH: 21-COMPENSATION-AND-ARR-SCENARIOS.MD · SALARY: GLASSDOOR MUNICH/BERLIN 2026

ONE FOR ALL. ALL FOR PROCUREMENT.

Thank you

Ready to start before day 0. The machine is already running.

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Appendix: the working files

Every claim in this deck has a file behind it. Nothing here is slideware.

SPREADSHEET

Lio_ICP_Prospect_List.xlsx · 13-icp-prospect-list.md

Named-buyer list across 4 ICP segments. Companies, titled contacts with LinkedIn URLs, Apollo match totals, per-persona approach playbook, executive summary.

SPREADSHEET

16-event-status-update.md + Lio_P1_Event_Status_2026-08-31.csv

60 scored events across US/UK/EU-DACH in P1/P2/P3 tiers. Every P1 date, venue and deadline re-verified against organiser sources; passed deadlines flagged, changes annotated.

SPREADSHEET

Lio_P1_Budget_Staffing.csv

Quarter-by-quarter budget and staffing for the 17-event P1 programme: €736K new + €105K committed + contingency ≈ €929K, 204 staff-days, founder allocation, hiring triggers.

HYPOTHESIS

17-gtm-hypothesis-and-test-roadmap.md · 18-trigger-group-outreach-angles.md · Lio_H1_Test_Scorecard.csv

The strongest GTM bet as a falsifiable card with kill criteria and decision gates, the 35-account Renewal Radar with an evidence grade per row, and first-touch drafts for the six trigger accounts.

REGISTER

14-linkedin-posts.md

Every publicly indexed LinkedIn post about Lio found across 8 search angles: company, founders, team, events, customers, investors, German-language, third-party commentary.

KNOWLEDGE BASE

00–12 · Lio knowledge base

The sourced dossier this work builds on: company, product, pain points, competitive map, customer proof, strategic levers. Every fact graded for reliability.

PLAYBOOK

19-september-action-sheet.md · 20-event-strategy-and-icp-baseline.md

29 September actions ordered by due date with the three calls that cannot slip, plus recomputed ICP firmographics, the seat-per-room map and the preparation protocol by tier.

MODEL

21-compensation-and-arr-scenarios.md

The math behind the ask. Salary benchmarked to Munich/Berlin market data, and three H1 ARR scenarios built on file 17's own decision-gate thresholds. Every figure marked modeled, not forecast.

THIS DECK

15-deck-design.md · 19-lio-brand-language-and-agents.md

The design spec: MBB formatting, Inter (saved in deck-design/fonts/), the brand/tone register, and the placeholders still owed (photo).

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